

Ismailli Kryz

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1. Introduction

1.1. Area and speakers

Kryz is a small dialect continuum numbering at most 2,000 speakers scattered in fewer than ten small localities of northeastern Azerbaijan, in the districts of Quba to the north and Ismailli to the south, separated by the Greater Caucasus mountain range. Speakers identify as Azerbaijani Muslims, with their ‘own language’ at the village level. The general name come from the village Qırız (q’ırıc’) which used to be most powerful but is nowadays reduced to a dozen of permanent households.

1.2. Dialects

Four dialects of Kryz (Kryz proper, Jek, Alik-Haput, and Ismailli) are still spoken as a first language in Qırız, Qırızdəhnə, Cek, Əlik, Haput, Hacıhətəmli and Mollaisaqlı villages. A fifth dialect, close to Kryz proper, used to be spoken in the now abandoned village of Yergüc. Its speakers have joined other Kryz families that relocated in the lowlands of the Quba and Khachmaz regions.

This paper examines the southernmost dialect of Kryz, spoken in two villages (Hacıhətəmli and Mollaisaqlı) at the southern edge of the Ismailli district, closer to the center of the neighbouring district of Göyçay. Our presentation is based on restricted material consisting mainly of the translation, dictated by Nahida Vahidli, of an Azeri folktale that I generally use to get acquainted with new linguistic varieties. I focus on features diverging from those of the Alik dialect, described in my 2009 grammar and in particular on those shared with the other dialects (Jek and Kryz proper) but absent in Alik. This short sketch is but a step towards a comparative study of the whole Southern Lezgi continuum (Kryz dialects and Budugh).

1.3. Sociolinguistic situation

Kryz dialects are unwritten; the language of instruction in both elementary and intermediate schools is Azeri, which is well known by all adults and used in communication with speakers of other languages. The language contact situation between Kryz and Azeri being asymmetrical, the direction of copying has been from dominant Azeri to dominated Kryz. Kryz is very seldom written by its speakers. Some younger people send text messages and write on social media in Kryz using the Azeri Latin alphabet, overlooking the ejective feature on stops.

1.4. State of research

The dissertation by Saadiev (year?) attempts to cover all Kryz varieties, as was common in the tradition of Tbilisi State University, where it was defended in 1972. It contains much valuable information on the morphology and the lexicon but there is no consideration of the morphosyntax, and the texts, collected from not always fully competent speakers, are transcribed phonetically with much incoherence. The publication of a reedited version of these texts would be very useful. In the 1970s and 1980s, a few of articles by Khidirov (years?) have contributed to a better understanding of the morphology. My dissertation, defended in 2004 and published in 2009 (Authier 2009), is a detailed description of the dialect of Alik, chosen for its centrality and the availability of an outstanding consultant (Majlis Shamseddinov). I have also worked on the dialects of Jek and to a lesser extent Kryz proper, but these materials await publication. In 2016, Monika Rind-Pawłowski started working on a dictionary of Kryz proper, of which a first version was published in 2019 and contains a useful grammatical sketch written in Azeri. An improved second edition for Language Science Press is currently being edited. Upon discovering through social media that young fluent speakers were still present in the region of Ismailli, we decided to go there in March 2017 with the purpose of carrying out fieldwork. I was surprised to find a blooming community of very competent speakers and a language preserved as fully as the dialects spoken in the mountains.

1.5. Language history

Despite the ubiquitous bilingualism with Azeri, Kryz preserves all typical East Caucasian and specifically Lezgian features. It shares a considerable number of isoglosses, mainly lexical, with Budugh, but also clear common innovations, such as the use of the inherited adlocative case markers on imperfective verb stems to express a debitive mood (Authier 2010a). The peripheral dialects of Ismailli Kryz and Kryz proper share some archaic features in the finite verbal forms. Residents of the villages of Mollaisaqlı and Hacıhətəmli claim their origin in Haput, though they no longer communicate with the ancestral village, whose dialect has probably been deeply influenced in recent times by the dialect of nearby Alik, where children go to the secondary school. The main isogloss linking Ismailli Kryz with Haput is the preservation of gender-number and direct/oblique case agreement on modifiers in the noun phrase. No common innovation sets them apart.

2. Phonology

2.1. Segments, script and transcription

The consonants of Ismaili Kryz are given in Table 1:

Table 1. Kryz consonants

		Labia l	Denta l	Postalv eolar	Palata l	Velar	Uvula r	Pharyngea l	Glotta l
Stop	ejective	p'	t'			k', k ^w	q', q ^w		ʔ
	aspirated	p	t			k, k ^w	q, q ^w		
	voiced	b	d			g, g ^w	ɣ, ɣ ^w		
Affricate	ejective		c'	č'					
	aspirated			č					
	voiced			ž					
Fricative	voiced		z			ɣ	[g]	ʕ	
	voiceless	v	s	š		x, x ^w	χ, χ ^w	ħ	h
Sonorant		m	n						
			r, l						
					j				

Similar to some other languages of the region, /ɣ/ is realized as a stop [g] at onsets and after consonants (sonorants), and may be devoiced as [χ] in coda position. Apart from a tendency to drop *q'* or replace it with ʔ, a striking defining feature of the Ismaili dialect, as opposed to all other dialects of Kryz including Haput, is the absence of *f*, replaced in Azeri loans with *x^w* (*x^wundux* 'hazelnut', *hax^wta* 'week', *nax^war* 'person'). Given the geographical situation of this dialect, this is a paradox, which can only be explained by a reflex of identity. Since this dialect has lost the exclusive first-person pronoun, there is no phoneme *ž* left.

Table 2. Kryz vocalic phonemes

i		u
e		o
	a	

Our transcription being phonological, it does not reflect all the phonetic nuances found for the vowels:

- speakers of all Kryz dialects transcribe their language using the Azerbaijani graphemes *a* and *ə*, with varying degrees of success in achieving coherence. Both are conditioned realizations of /a/ in contact with either back or front consonants;

- the sound *o* is more consistently found in Ismailli and Kryz proper than in Alik, but I have chosen to restore the underlying diphthongs (*va* and *av*) in all positions.

Ismailli Kryz tends to break consonant clusters at morpheme junctions with a schwa, realized as *i*, or *u* in labial context. Labial harmony (for which see Authier 2010c) is reflected in our transcription: **zuz-in-i* [ant-obl-gen] > *zuz-unu*, etc.

The prosody of Ismailli Kryz does not differ substantially from that of the other dialects: nouns and nominalized forms are stressed on the final syllable while finite verb forms bear stress on the first syllable.

3. Morphology: word classes and inflection

The complex, mainly agglutinative and suffixal morphology of Kryz is very well preserved in the Ismailli dialect.

3.1. Nouns

3.2.1. Genders

The gender-number system comprises five “gender-number agreement classes”: human masculine (M), human feminine and other animates (F, which also includes supernatural creatures except God, many inanimates and certain abstract concepts), other inanimate (N for ‘neuter’), non-human plural (NPL), and human plural (HPL). Feminine nouns denoting non-humans include the following:

- all animals, regardless of sex, e.g. *lem* ‘donkey’, *zuz* ‘ant’, as well as *div* ‘demon’ and plants like *ječ* ‘apple’;
- many body parts, e.g. *q’il* ‘head’, *ižin* ‘face’, *mez* ‘tongue’;
- nouns denoting speech acts and mental or body activities, e.g. *c’uru* ‘shout’, *kalak* ‘ruse’, *huš* ‘conscience’, *tapuk* ‘kick’, *dařava* ‘quarrel’;
- other less predictable nouns like *dahar* ‘stone’, *k’ul* ‘house’, *vuraḅ* ‘sun’, *čut* ‘pair’, *jaba* ‘pitchfork’, *davr* ‘period’, *elaž* ‘cure’, *kup* ‘pot’, *kursi* ‘seat’, *sandux* ‘chest’, *dux* ‘ayran’.

3.2.2. Oblique stems and number marking

The main plural suffixes on nouns are, in the nominative, *-(j)ar*, *-(i)bi* and additionally in Ismailli Kryz *-(i)ber* and *-ni*.

Nouns inflect for a rich case paradigm (close to 20 forms in the dialect of Ismailli, not all available of all nouns), distinguishing nominative vs. ‘oblique’ cases derived from an oblique stem.

Whereas other East Caucasian languages, including Lezgif (and to the exclusion of Kryz’ closest relative, Budugh, for which see Authier In prep.), derive their genitive case from an oblique stem, the Kryz genitive coincides with the oblique stem for the great majority of nominals. The default genitive-oblique suffix is *-ži*, which in Ismailli Kryz became *-ji* after vowels, e.g. *adami-ji neŋ* [person-GEN smell] ‘human smell’.

For inanimate and lower animate nouns, the suffixes used for this genitive-oblique derivation display considerable allomorphy. Among other oblique marking morphemes *-l*, *-n*, and *-rd* take a buffer vowel before the sonorant (*žib* ‘pocket’ > inessive *žib-un-a*, *jux* ‘night’ > inessive *jux-un-a*, *lem* ‘donkey’ > dative *lem-ird-iz*). The default timbre is [i], or [u] if the root already contains an [u] or after any labial (v, b, m) or labialized consonant root-finally. In Ismailli Kryz, these take an additional *i* (u after labialized stem) to form the genitive.

A tendency to use the inessive form as a new oblique stem is generally observed and is at work also in Budugh. In Alik, it affects personal pronouns and some nouns situated high in the animacy hierarchy. In Ismailli Kryz, the genitive coincides with the locative case for nouns denoting human possessors, a contrast made clear in the example below. Here, the ending *-ža* is used in locative function on the noun denoting a place but in genitive function on the noun denoting a human referent, while the noun denoting an animal takes the genitive ending *-ji*:

) *tažir-ža* *balka-ji* *bazma-ža* *ažir-d*.
 merchant-obl.in horse-gen stable-obl.in sleep.pf-aor(m)

‘He slept in the merchant’s horsestables.’

3.2.3. Grammatical cases

Four grammatical cases are common to all dialects, as well as eighteen spatial cases.

Table 3. Ismailli Kryz grammatical cases and main types of declension

NOM	<i>k’ul</i> ‘house’	<i>xu</i> ‘bread’	<i>xuri</i> ‘man’	<i>tažir</i> ‘merchant’	<i>kum</i> ‘village’
GEN	<i>k’ul-ži</i>	<i>xu-ji</i>	<i>xur-a</i>	<i>tažir-ža</i>	<i>kum</i>
ERG	<i>k’ul-ži-r</i>	<i>xu-ji-r</i>	<i>xur-a-r</i>	<i>tažir-ži-r</i>	<i>kum-ur</i>
DAT	<i>k’ul-ži-z</i>	<i>xu-ji-z</i>	<i>xur-a-z</i>	<i>tažir-ži-z</i>	<i>kum-uz</i>

Higher animate nouns ending in *a* like *gada* ‘boy’ or *darɤa* ‘judge’ have the same form for the genitive and the nominative, but take the oblique suffix *-ji* for further cases, e.g. *darɤa-jɪ-r* etc.

3.2.4. Spatial cases

Although the morphology of the eighteen spatial cases is more or less the same across Kryz dialects, their inventory, frequency and semantic domains vary considerably. In Ismailli Kryz, the wider use of spatial postpositions accounts for the fact that some original cases have downright disappeared or become more vague, acquiring argument-marking functions or marginalized to lexically restricted uses. The labels chosen aim at transparency refer to cognates in related languages. Note that a third of the slots are empty in Ismailli Kryz: this rampant defectivity paved the way to the even less transparent systems found in Budugh or Udi.

Table 4. Ismailli Kryz spatial case markers

	ESSIVE	LATIVE	ELATIVE
IN	<i>-a(ʕ)</i>	<i>-aʕan</i>	<i>-aʕ-ar</i>
SUPER & SUPEREL	<i>-ɤ</i>	-	<i>-ɤ-ar</i>
SUB & PART	<i>-k</i>	-	<i>-kir</i>
ADR & ADEL	-	<i>-van</i>	<i>-var</i>
DIR	-	<i>-χʷan</i>	-
APUD & APUDEL	<i>-vas</i>	-	<i>-vas-ar</i>

Nouns with a sonorant oblique extension drop the Ismailli Kryz *i/u* of the genitive before the other cases, e.g. *dib* ‘bottom’ > gen. *dibini* > *kuji-ji dib-in-a* [pit-GEN bottom-OBL-IN] ‘at the bottom of the pit’.

Illative forms in *-an* are still used consistently in the dialects of Jek and Kryz proper. In Alik, as well as in Ismailli, they are obsolete or rare (ex. 1), while original essive cases have become general “locatives”, i.e. are used with both essive and lative values (ex. 2):

- 1) *nahčuvan* *igir-a* *kʷul-ʒaʕan* *di-xr-i*.
 evening refl.pl-gen house-obl.illat neg-go-aor
 ‘He did not go home for the night.’

- 2) *za* *čantaj-ʒa* *kʷiba* *xu* *čʷičʷak* *ʕa-v!*
 1.gen bag-obl.in little bread onion pv.f.put_in(imper)
 ‘Pack some bread and onion in my bag!’

The superlocative (-*κ*) has extended its domain in the Ismaili dialect at the expense of two other locatives. In the following example, the first instance of the superlocative is correlated with the preverb of the verb meaning ‘to put on’, whereas the second instance is not, and the precise spatial meaning is blurred. The lative form has disappeared in Ismaili Kryz, but the superrelative (-*kar*) is still in use (ex. 3):

- 3) *bašmaκ-ar adami-ji-r ugur-a kil-iκ ki-t-a-žxala*
 shoe-pl person-obl-erg refl.m-gen leg-super pv-put_on-pf-cv:after
luma t'a-rhar-e ki kuš=in a-ji-κ su-rq 'war-da-b.
 so pv-ipf.run-prs that bird=add 3-obl.nh-super pv-ipf.reach-hab.neg-f

‘As soon as one puts the shoes on, they can run so fast that even a bird could not catch up with them.’

- 4) *sa-d hax^wta tažir ugur-a čikar-i-κar ku-žr-az da-xa.*
 one-n week merchant refl.m-gen bed-obl-superel pv-stand_up.pf-inf neg-be.pf(aor)
 ‘The merchant could not move from his bed for a week.’

The superrelative also conveys the meaning ‘about’:

- 5) *ziva-van hal-iκar lup-uda kač'-ini-κar.*
 1+2.obl-adr who.obl-superel say.pf-hort cat-obl-superel

‘Whom shall I tell you about? About the cat.’

The adlocative case (-*ν*) has disappeared in the dialect of Ismaili, and the lative and elative forms have only argument-marking functions. The adelative case (-*var*) is found in the context of social interaction, for instance:

- 6) *ahmad div-un-uvar žura xaj-id.*
 Ahmad monster-obl-adel apart be.pf-aor(m)

‘Ahmed took leave of the demon.’

As in the other dialects, the original adlative case (-*van*) is used with speech verbs to encode the addressee and the non permanent recipient:

7) *daha kizil-bi tu-κ-a igir-a badaj-van vuj-iž.*
 quickly gold-pl pv-carry-pf(seq) refl.hpl-gen grandmother-adr give.pf-aor.n
 ‘He took the gold to his grandmother immediately.’

The sublocative is rare and lexically restricted:

8) *aji-ž xu ugur-a sili-k ji-γ-i ula-ž ika-ženi.*
 dry-attr.n bread refl.m-gen tooth-sub pv-pull.pf-seq eat.pf-msd want-perf.pst
 ‘He gnawed at the stale bread, wanting to eat it.’

The sublative has disappeared in Ismaili Kryz. As in the other dialects, the original subelative has become a partitive case:

9) *kačal-ži-r lu xij-kir řac'in-ža kira ji-xir-d.*
 bald-obl-erg this water.obl-part satiated-adv drink.pf pv-go.pf-aor(m)
 ‘The Bald Man drank from the source to his fill and continued his journey.’

The directive case is rare in Ismaili but remains obligatory with the verb *ikaž* ‘to look (at)’:

10) *iž-a řajarxin-uχun ik!*
 ref.f-gen beauty-dir look(imper)
 ‘Look at her beauty!’

Finally, instances of the apudlocative (-*vas*, rare in other dialects) are found in Ismaili:

11) *mix^wtar-be řuran halma je-ni ja-vas.*
 wedding-pl.in before so cop-pst 1pl.obl-apud
 ‘At weddings, it was like this, before, by us.’

With regard to the apudelative, note the idiomatic *daj-vasar xajiž* [***add glosses] ‘lit. to become from mother > to be born’.

Derivation of nouns in Ismaili Kryz is restricted to deadjectival derivation of abstract nouns, e.g. *řajara* ‘nice’ > *řajar-xin* ‘beauty’, *γira* ‘hot’ > *γira-xin* ‘heat’.

3.3. Adjectives

Two denominal adjectival suffixes – the proprietive *-li* and the privative *-siz* (subject to vowel harmony) – are copied from Azeri. They are extremely productive, e.g. *ež-li* *ʃajal-li* ‘provided with wife and children’, *žiri-siz* ‘beard-less’, *k’ul-suz* ‘home-less’.

- 12) *karč-imi* *niza-ji-ʁana-ž* *jiji-b* *q’il-li*
 horn-pl.nom spear-gen-like-attr.pl seven-f head-ed
 ‘with seven heads whose horns were like spears’

Postpositions and some inflected nominal forms like *q’anik* ‘under’ or *ʃade* ‘above’ can also derive adjectives:

- 13) *q’anika-ž* *p’iz-in-ir* *q’im* *varx-ire*,
 lower-attr.obl lip-obl-erg ground pv.ipf.sweep-prs(n)
ʃade-ž *p’iz-in-ir* *zav* *varx-ire*.
 upper-attr.obl lip-obl-erg sky pv.ipf.sweep-prs(n)

‘Its lower lip sweeps the ground, its upper lip sweeps the sky.’

Substantivized adjectives and other attributes take the following gender-depending case endings (preceded by an *a* for derived adjectives):

Table 5. Kryz gender and number suffixes on substantivized attributes

	HUMAN	NON-HUMAN F	N	NPL	HPL
NOM	<i>-d</i>	<i>-d</i>	<i>-ž</i>	<i>-bi</i>	<i>-žib</i>
GEN	<i>-n</i>	<i>-ž a / ji</i>	<i>-ž a / ji</i>	<i>-be</i>	<i>-anda</i>
ERG	<i>-n-ir</i>	<i>-ž-ir /-j-ir</i>	<i>-ž-ir /-j-ir</i>	<i>-be-r</i>	<i>-anda-r</i>
etc					

- 14) *beli-n-ivan* *luʁur-a=vun=ki...*
 big-h-adr say.ipf-hab=2=that

‘You will say to the caravan driver...’

- 15) *q’ara-n-iz* *vuc’un-žav=zin*.
 naked-h-dat give.f.ipf-fut.f=1

‘I will give it to someone who has no home, who is naked.’

3.4. Pronouns

Speech Act Participants are expressed by free or cliticized pronouns with no ergative marking (cf. Authier 2008). The demonstrative system is not elaborate. Reflexive and reciprocal constructions make use of special reflexive and reciprocal pronouns.

3.4.1. Personal pronouns

The forms of the first- and second-person plural pronouns differ across Kryz dialects. In Ismaili Kryz, the first-person plural exclusive has been lost. The second-person plural pronoun, lost in Alik, is retained:

Table 6. Ismaili Kryz personal pronouns

	1SG	2SG	1PL	2PL
NOM / ERG	<i>zin</i>	<i>vun</i>	<i>jin</i>	<i>vin</i>
GEN	<i>za</i>	<i>va</i>	<i>ja</i>	<i>ve</i>
DAT	<i>zaz</i>	<i>vaz</i>	<i>jaz</i>	<i>vez</i>
SUPER	<i>zab</i>	<i>vab</i>	<i>jab</i>	<i>veb</i>

The first-person pronoun in subject function (non-patient nominative or ergative case) becomes cliticized to a second-person pronoun yielding the following forms: *zi-vun* or *zuvun*, *zi-vin*, *ji-vun*, *ji-vin*.

Personal pronouns in the genitive are substantivized by means of the adjectival suffix *-a*. in this case the original locative (> genitive) morpheme *-f* surfaces:

- 16) *zaʃa-d* *sa-b* *veʃa-d*
 mine-attr.f one-f yours(pl)-attr.f

‘one mine, one yours’

3.4.2. Demonstrative pronouns

Kryz has three demonstrative pronouns: *u-d* ‘this’, *a-d* ‘that’ and *am* ‘that near you’. Their nominative endings and oblique stems are gender- and number-marked, like adjectives, allowing reference tracking, e.g. *u-n-a jan-ža* [this-H-GEN side-OBL.LOC] ‘near him or her’ / *u-j jan-ža* [this-NH.GEN side-OBL.LOC] ‘near it’:

- 17) *i-d-qa-ž* *ki* *u-d* *kačal* *da-r.*
 pv-n-see.pf-aor.n that this-m.nom bald neg.cop-m

‘They saw that it was not the Bald Man.’

Locative forms of these demonstrative pronouns serve for the expression of deixis and anaphora:

- 18) *ši* *a-ž-ašar* *u-ž-ašar* *v-ažan-av* *vun?*
 what that-nh-inel this-nh-inel f-talk.ipf-prs.f 2

‘Stop talking nonsense (lit. from here from there)!’

Kryz has three demonstrative adjectives: *lu*, *la* and *lam*, which correspond to the demonstrative pronouns and can be emphasized by the prefix *ha-*, yielding *halu*, *hala*, *halam*.

Reduction of first-person pronouns (dropping final *n*) and procliticization of second-person pronouns occurs before a third-person demonstrative but with obligatory vowel copying from the demonstrative, e.g. *zuʔud* (1+3prox), *zaʔad*, *vunud*, *vanad*, etc.:

- 19) *sa-d* *baʔ=e* *šaše* *vana-ž* *kaʔkul!*
 one-n garden=cop come.imper 2+3-n pv.n.dig.pf(imper)

‘I have a garden, come and dig it up!’

3.4.3. Reflexive pronouns

First- and second-person reflexive pronouns are derived from the personal pronouns and mainly found in the genitive case:

- 20) *zina* *šul-iž* *aʔur* *ka-jin-da.*
 1.refl.gen eye-obl-gen sleep pv-take.pf-hort

‘I shall get my rest.’

- 21) *baštamiš* *ar* *vuna* *duru* *lip-iž!*
 start do.pf 2.refl.gen false say.pf-msd

‘Start telling your lie!’

Third-person reflexive pronouns have the following paradigm in the Ismaili dialect, characterized by variation between older forms and recent forms derived by analogy:

Table 7. The third person intensive / reflexive pronoun in Ismaili Kryz

	M	F/N	NPL	HPL
NOM	<i>ug</i>	<i>iž</i>	<i>ibi</i>	<i>ig-eb</i>
ERG	<i>ug-ur</i>	<i>iž-ir</i>	<i>ib-er</i>	<i>ig-er</i>
GEN	<i>ug-a / ugur-a</i>	<i>iž-a</i>	<i>ibir-a</i>	<i>ig-a / igir-e</i>
DAT	<i>ugura-z</i>	<i>iža-z</i>	<i>ibira-z</i>	<i>iga-z / igir-ez</i>

22)	<i>ugur-a</i>	<i>ižin</i>	<i>bulaκ-ži</i>	<i>xijža</i>	<i>juqu</i>
	refl.m-gen	face(f)	spring-gen	water.obl.in	pv.f.hold.seq
	<i>ugur-a</i>	<i>šakil-ži-χ^wan</i>	<i>ika-ž.</i>		
	refl.m-gen	image-obl-dir	look-aor.n		

‘He looked at the waterspring, and saw in it his reflection.’

23)	<i>q'al-ar</i>	<i>jit-iž</i>	<i>ibir-a</i>	<i>juva-jar-a.</i>
	mouse-pl	n.pass.pf-aor.n	refl.npl-gen	nest-pl-in

‘The mice passed into their nests.’

24)	<i>a-nda-r</i>	<i>ula</i>	<i>κir-a-ž.</i>	<i>igir-a</i>	<i>čikar-iκ</i>	<i>je-b-x-ižib.</i>
	that-hpl-erg	eat.pf	drink-pf-aor.n	refl.hpl-gen	place-super	pv-hpl-pass.pf-aor.hpl

‘They ate and drank and lived happily ever after.’

In the second and third person (and in the first person for the dialects which preserve the clusivity contrast), a plural form is required when mentioning family elders: *ve / igira badaj* ‘your, their grandmother’. The contrast can be observed in the following example:

25)	<i>ug-a</i>	<i>q'ali-κ</i>	<i>va-xir-bi</i>	<i>igir-a</i>	<i>badaj-iz</i>	<i>ažin-d.</i>
	refl.m-gen	head.obl-super	pv-happen.pf-npl.nom	refl.hpl-gen	grandmother-dat	tell.pf-aor(m)

‘He told his grandmother about his adventures.’

3.4.4. Interrogative and indefinite pronouns

The interrogative pronouns vary slightly across dialects. They are *ti* ‘who’ (erg. *hal-ir*), *ši* ‘what / which’ (erg. ???), *hala* ‘where’, *čikara* ‘how much’, and ??? ‘when’ in Ismaili Kryz.

26)	<i>vun</i>	<i>ši</i>	<i>lužur-e=vun?</i>
	2	what	say.ipf-prs=2

‘What are you saying?’

- 27) *va gada-jar-var hal-iz kijšar-e?*
 2.gen boy-pl-adel who.obl-dat fear.ipf-prs

‘Who is afraid of your sons?’

Ismaili Kryz has both dedicated indefinite pronouns and creates new ones from conditional relative clauses:

- 28) *ug-a q’ali-κ kačal-luκ^wal-žī-kir hešin ji-d-kin-dad.*
 refl.m-gen head.obl-super bald-ness.obl-part anything pv-n-remain.pf-neg.perf.n

‘There is not a single trace of baldness left on his head.’

- 29) *χiš-in-i sa-b q’il šiji-κ je-ž xa-jnam ζaku-d.*
 plough-obl-gen one-f head(f) thing.obl-super cop-attr.n be.pf-cond pv.f.hit.pf-aor

‘The tip of his plough got caught in something.’

3.5. Numerals

All the lower numerals bear gender markers of the strong type also found on some of the perfective verb stems. For thirty and higher, the Azeri or Persian numerals are used in Ismaili Kryz.

Table 8. Kryz numerals

1	<i>sa-r, -b, -d</i>	6	<i>rix-ir, rix-ib, rix-id</i>	11	<i>c’inna sa-r...</i>
2	<i>q’^wa-r, -b, -d</i>	7	<i>jij-ir, jīj-ib, jīj-id</i>	20	<i>κa-r, κa-b, κa-d</i>
3	<i>šub-ur, šub, šub-ud</i>	8	<i>muj-ir, muj-ib, muj-id</i>	21	<i>κanna sa-r, -b, -d</i>
4	<i>juq’-ur, juq’-ub, juq’-ud</i>	9	<i>juč’-ur, juč’-ub, juč’-ud</i>		
5	<i>xu-r, xu-b, xu-d</i>	10	<i>jic’-ir, jic’-ib, jic’-id</i>		

- 30) *za-κ muji-b div-a-d diχ=e=za-κ.*
 1.obl-super eight-f ogre(f)-gen-attr.m son=cop=1.obl-super

‘I have seven ogre sons.’

-) *q’^wa-d šubu-d ugur-a žib-un-a a-ja-ž*
 two-n three-n refl.m-gen pocket-obl-in pv-n.put.pf-aor.n

‘He put some of them in his pocket.’

If the head noun is in an oblique case, the numeral can take a special oblique suffix *-ži* (ex. 31) or not (ex. 32):

- 31) *rix-ži jaš-in-a majin jina miz-aſan b-ažin-že-b=jin.*
 six-obl year-obl-in until 1pl.ref.gen tongue.obl-lat hpl-speak.pf-perf-hpl=1pl
 ‘Until six years old, we spoke in our language.’

- 32) *c'in-na ſub-ud jaš-in-a ji-pi-žav xura-z*
 ten-and three-n year-obl-in pv-f.go.pf-perf.f man.obl-dat
 ‘She was married when (she was) thirteen years old.’

Substantivized numerals, like adjectives, inflect for case with gender-marked oblique stems. Collective numerals are expressed by the additive enclitic particle *=in / =un*, or *=an* after a genitive in *-a(ſ)*:

- 33) *q'und-ur=un kizil-ži-kir xajli va-ſ-a ka-jin-ž.*
 two.obl.h-erg=add gold-obl-part much pv-gather-pf pv-take.pf-aor.n
 ‘The two gathered much of the gold and carried it away.’

- 34) *ja q'undaſan duru k'iba-ž e.*
 1pl.gen two.h.gen.add false little-attr.n cop
 ‘Both our lies are equally small.’

For ordinals, the Azeri suffix is borrowed, e.g. *mujb-inži* ‘eightth’.

Azeri ordinals replace the native higher numeral lexemes in Ismaili Kryz:

- 35) *div-ne birxinži utak-ž-a kilitdi sa-b sanduk javr.*
 ogre-pl.in fortieth room-obl-in locked one-f chest cop.f
 ‘In the fortieth room of the ogres’ house, there is a chest.’

General quantifiers are *xajli* ‘much’ and *k'iba* ‘not much’:

- 36) *xajli jip-ižib k'iba kabt'il-žib.*
 much pv.f.go.pf-aor.hpl little pv.hpl.stand.pf-aor.hpl
 ‘They walked a lot, they did not stop much...’

3.6. Verbs

Kryz verbs comprize a closed class of synthetic verbs, which inflect with prefixes for gender-number, imperfective aspect and negation, and with suffixes for perfective aspect, tense and moods, as well as gender-number and negation (depending on finiteness and tense-moods). An expanding class of compound verbs combines various types of coverbs with auxiliaries.

3.6.1. Root structure of synthetic verbs

Synthetic verbs form a closed class comprising some 200 items. They are either transitive or intransitive, a distinction which is marked morphologically on imperfective stems only. All of the 70 synchronically underived intransitive verbs display on their imperfective verb stem one of three allomorphs of the suffix *-aR* (*-ar/-al/-an*). Conversely, the 130 transitive synthetic verbs do not show these suffixes.

Most synthetic verbs have a preverb after which gender, negation and aspect markers can be inserted. Preverbs are often correlated with spatial case markers (ex. 37), but these correlations are less consistent in Ismailli Kryz than in the mountain dialects (ex. 38):

- 37) *pišuk-žuk* *ku-lq'an-a*.
pussy-obl.super pv-ipf.mount-hab

‘He is used to mounting a cat’

- 38) *a-d* *ležux-ža* *ča-r-ku...*
3-h.nom blanket-obl.in pv-m-wrap.seq

‘having wrapped him in a blanket’

Nouns trigger gender-number agreement both on their modifiers and on verbs if they are in the nominative, i.e. if they are the patient of transitive predicates or the subject or stimulus of intransitive predicates.

Non-human plural nouns trigger singular ‘neutral’ agreement on all targets:

- 39) *ji-d-kin-ž* *q'al-ar-ir* *pitin* *xu-jni* *ula-ž*.
pv.n.remain.pf-attr.obl mouse-pl-erg all bread-pl eat.pf-aor.n

‘The remaining mice ate all the meals.’

Gender-number agreement with S/P (Single argument or Patient) nouns is pre- or infixed to the lexical stems of synthetic verbs. Person is mostly expressed by pronouns, which tend to be

reduplicated as clitics after the verb. The overall morphological structure of finite verb forms is outlined in the following table.

Table 9. Kryz verbs template

-3	preverb (usually with transparent spatial meaning)
-3	negation (aorist and non finite forms)
-2	prefixes cross-referencing the gender-number of S/P
-1	aspect-marking sonorant (- <i>r</i> , - <i>l</i> , - <i>n</i>)
0	root consonant
+1	perfective aspect or detransitivity markers
+2	Tense & Mood suffixes, including negation
+3	suffixes cross-referencing the gender-number of S/P (S/A in imperatives)
+4	past tense suffix <i>-ni</i>

Note that non-finite forms (and aorist forms in Ismailli and Kryz proper) have a prefixed negation marker while (other) finite forms have the negation expressed with the TAM suffix:

40)	<i>ež-ir</i>	<i>č'ir</i>	<i>d-ir-d</i>	<i>k'ul</i>
	woman-erg	destroy	neg-do.ipf-attr.f	house(f)
	<i>min</i>	<i>san</i>	<i>vu-lč'an-dabu.</i>	
	thousand	year	pv-collapse.ipf-hab.neg.f	

‘The house that a woman does not destroy will not collapse in a thousand years.’

The number of verb stems varies across dialects, with two main stems opposing perfective and imperfective aspect. A more complex situation obtains in Ismailli Kryz, where two variants – long and short - of the perfective stem are distinguished, and a third stem is used as a coverb of the auxiliary ‘to do’ in causative compounds.

3.6.2. Perfective tenses

Perfective stems are either radical (coinciding with the root) or thematic (ending in *a*) or ending in a sonorant, which in dialects other than Alik is not present in the sequential form. Gender marking can be strong (with *b-* in the feminine form and on some verbs *r-* in the masculine and *d-* in the neuter forms) or weak (with *v-* or vowel rounding in the feminine form).

Table 10. Paradigms of the aorist in Kryz

	radical type	thematic type	sonorant types		
	‘to enter’	‘to see’	‘to take out’	‘to remain’	‘to return’
M	<i>ʕa-čʼ-id</i>	<i>i-r-q-a-d</i>	<i>ʕa-q-ir-d</i>	<i>ji-l-k-in-d</i>	<i>la-sil-d</i>
F	<i>ʕa-b-čʼ-id(u)</i>	<i>i-b-q-a-d(u)</i>	<i>ʕa-q-ur-d(u)</i>	<i>ji-b-k-un-d(u)</i>	<i>la-b-sul-d(u)</i>
N	<i>ʕa-čʼ-iž</i>	<i>i-d-q-a-ž</i>	<i>ʕa-q-ir-ž</i>	<i>ji-d-k-in-ž</i>	<i>la-s-il-ž</i>
HPL	<i>ʕa-b-čʼ-ižib</i>	<i>i-b-q-a-žib</i>	<i>ʕa-b-q-ir-žib</i>	<i>ji-b-k-un-žib</i>	<i>la-b-sul-žib</i>
SEQ	<i>ʕa-čʼ-i</i> etc	<i>i-r-q-a</i> etc	<i>ʕa-q-i</i> etc	<i>ji-l-k-i</i> etc	<i>la-s-i</i> etc

	‘to be’	‘to do’
M	<i>xaj-id</i>	<i>ar-d</i>
F	<i>xʷaj-du</i>	<i>v-ar-d-u</i>
N	<i>xaj-iž</i>	<i>ar-ž</i>
HPL	<i>xaj-žib</i>	<i>b-ar-žib</i>
SEQ	<i>xaj-i</i>	<i>ar-i</i> etc

The aorist ... <<add info on how it is derived and what it means>>

- 41) *ug-a* *ež-a* *čʼal* *xura* *χʷaš-in-a* *ʕa-xir-ž*.
 refl.m-gen wife-gen word man.gen pleasure-obl-in pv-come.pf-aor.n

‘The man liked what his wife had said.’

Negation is prefixed for aorist forms of peripheral dialects (Kryz proper and Ismailli, but not Jek and Alik):

- 42) *ugura* *ʕul-ume-ʕ* *vudurʕuri*.
 m.refl.gen eye-pl.obl-super pf.neg.believe.aor

‘He could not believe his own eyes.’

- 43) *qʼab-ne* *sili-k* *jiyin-az* *sa-b* *karapʼ=in* *ji-di-b-kini*.
 plate-pl.in tooth-sub pv.pull.pf-inf one-f bone(a)=add pv-neg-f-remain-aor

‘Not a single bone was left on the plates to put under his tooth.’

The perfect describes the present result of a past event:

- 44) *kačal-ža χab-a χajli pul jedxi-že.*
bald-obl.in hand-in very money pv.n.pass.pf-perf

‘The Bald Man has got his hands on heaps of gold.’

- 45) *lu k’ul hal-ir řabt’un-žav?*
this house(f) who.obl-erg pv.f.build.pf-perf.f

‘Who has built this house?’

The pluperfect tense adds the final suffix *-ni* to the perfect:

- 46) *ug-a badaj-ir sa-b řajara-d k’ul řa-b-t’un-žu-ni.*
refl.m-gen grandmother-erg one-f good-attr.f house(f) pv-f-build.pf-perf.f-pst

‘His grandmother had had a beautiful mansion built.’

- 47) *χajli řalkin-že-ni.*
very pv.m.be_tired.pf-perf-pst

‘He was very tired.’

3.6.3. Imperfective tenses

All imperfective *intransitive* verb stems in Kryz add a suffix *–aR* (sonorant) after the root consonant.

Table 11. The present tense of intransitive verbs in Kryz

	‘to enter’	‘to mount’	‘to return’	‘to remain’	‘to see’	‘to be’
M	<i>řa-r č’-ar-e</i>	<i>ku-lq’an-e</i>	<i>la-lsal-e</i>	<i>jilkan-e</i>	<i>i-r-q-ar-e</i>	<i>řere</i>
F	<i>řa-r-č’-ar-av</i>	<i>ku-lq’an-av</i>	<i>la-lsal-av</i>	<i>jilkan-av</i>	<i>u-r-q-ar-av</i>	<i>řavrav</i>
N	<i>řa-r-č’-are</i>	<i>ku-lq’an-e</i>	<i>la-lsal-e</i>	<i>jilkan-e</i>	<i>i-r-q-ar-e</i>	<i>řere</i>
HPL	<i>řa-bi-r-č’-ar-eb</i>	<i>ku-bulq’an-eb</i>	<i>la-ba-lsal-eb</i>	<i>jilkan-eb</i>	<i>i-b-q-ar-eb</i>	<i>řabareb</i>
SIMUL	<i>řa-r č’-ar-a</i>	<i>ku-lq’an-a</i>	<i>la-lsal-a</i>	<i>jilkan-a</i>	<i>i-r-q-ar-a</i>	<i>řar-a</i>

Imperfective *transitive* verb stems in Kryz usually mark imperfective aspect with a sonorant *r*, *l*, *n* inserted just before the root consonant. In Alik Kryz, this sonorant is copied after it before finite endings. This regular pattern does not obtain in Ismailli Kryz.

Table 12.

	‘to take out’	‘to build’	‘to do’	‘to give’
M	<i>ka-r-q-ire</i>		<i>ir-e</i>	<i>vuc'in-e</i>
F	<i>ɤ^wa-r-q-urav</i>	<i>ʃalt'un-av</i>	<i>v-ir-av</i>	<i>vuc'un-av</i>
N	<i>ka-r-q-ire</i>	<i>ʃalt'in-e</i>	<i>ir-e</i>	<i>vuc'in-e</i>
HPL	<i>ka-bi-r-q-ireb</i>		<i>b-ir-eb</i>	<i>vuc'un-eb</i>
SIMUL	<i>ka-r-q-ir-a</i>	<i>ʃalt'in-a</i>	<i>ir-a</i>	<i>vuc'in-a</i>

As shown in the preceding tables, the **present tense** adds the copula (cf. the section on non-verbal predicates) to the stem. In Ismaili Kryz, one negative form is shared by the present (ex. 48) and the habitual (ex. 53) tenses. The habitual tense is formed from the imperfective stem using the suffixes *-a*, *-a(v)*, *ab*. Apart from habitual (49), it is used for gnomic value (50), unsure prospect (51), polite request (52) and deontic modality (53):

- 48) *abirt' šiz vaʃxu-rada-b=vun?*
 nut(f) why pv.ipf.gather.f-prs.neg-f=2

‘Why don’t you collect the nuts?’

- 49) *hisan čiba-ra=jin.*
 now go.hpl-hab1pl.nom

‘Now we’ll go.’

- 50) *kačal-ža žan q’ič’č’a šar-a.*
 bald-obl.in life strong be.ipf-hab

‘A bald man is always a survivor.’

- 51) *ti ɤ^wan-a-v=vun?*
 who.nom take.f.ipf-hab-f=2

‘Whom are you marrying?’

- 52) *za gada-jar-van luʔur-a=vun=ki...*
 1.gen boy-pl-adr say.ipf-hab=2=that

‘You will tell my sons that...’

- 53) *adamij-ir halama luʔur-da-d.*
 person-erg so say.ipf-neg.hab-n

‘One should not say that.’

Note that in the dialect of Ismaili, the present and habitual endings may remain *-e* and *-a* in the feminine form (instead of *-u* /*-av*, the verb stem remains gender marked) if a constituent is focussed:

- 54) *kʼul eʒ-ir ʃaltʼun-a.*
 house(f) wife-erg pv.ipf.f.build-hab

‘It is women who build houses.’

The imperfect tense adds the final suffix *-ni* to the present and habitual forms. In the Ismaili dialect, the human plural marker *-b* has moved into final position of positive forms, after the suffix *-ni*:

- 55) *meša-ža ʃul ʃul-i-z i-rqar-a-da-d-ni.*
 forest-obl.in eye eye-obl-dat pv-ipf.see-hab-neg-n-pst

‘In the forest the eye could not see the eye (lit. It was pitch-dark).’

- 56) *heč ugura čikar-i-ɰar ɰurzar-a-da-r-ni.*
 at_all m.refl.gen place-obl-superel pv.ipf.stand_up-hab-neg-m-pst

‘He would not stand up from his place.’

- 57) *adami-jar dava-jar tašna-ji-r b-ugar-eni-b.*
 person-pl camel-pl thirst-obl-erg hpl-burn.ipf-imperf.hpl

‘The camels were tormented by thirst.’

The forms for the future tense vary across the dialects. In Ismaili Kryz, it is formed from the imperfective stem by means of the suffixes *-že* (m/n/npl), *-žav* (f), *-žeb* (hpl). It is used for predictions:

- 58) *luža muji-b jaxi ʃa-bi-šxar-žeb.*
 here eight-f enemy pv-hpl-come.ipf-fut.hpl

‘Seven enemies will be coming here.’

3.6.3. Evidentiality

A conspicuous morphological element borrowed by Kryz is the Azeri morpheme *-miş*, an evidentiality-marking clitic. Its semantics are non-direct evidence *in the past* (not necessarily remote), hearsay, gnomic sentences, inference and mirativity. With regard to its combinatory properties with other TAM markers, the evidential clitic is found on most synthetic indicative verb forms and the copula but not on dedicated direct-assertion forms like the aorist. The following examples are based on the perfect, the present or habitual forms:

- 59) *sendeme kačal q'aj-dar=miş!*
 incredibly bald die.pf-perf.pst.m=evid

‘It turned out that the Bald Man was not really dead.’

- 60) *hala-ža zuz-unu jiq'-ži-κ sa-d κazma ζa-t'in-že=miş=ki*
 there-obl.in ant-obl.gen back-obl-super one-n stable pv-build.pf-perf=evid=that
pitin dunja-ža je-j-ž jaba-jar hala-ža aq-re=miş.
 all world-obl.in cop-ptcp-attr.npl pitchfork-pl there-obl.in (npl)hold.ipf-prs=evid

‘There, on the back of an ant, he constructed such a big barn that he could keep all the large pitchforks of the world in it.’

- 61) *za babaj-a κazma čikara bejli je=miş ki*
 1.gen grandfather-gen stable so_much big cop=evid that
halama-ž jaba-jar-e ki juz dana jurqu=ra=miş.
 so-attr.n pitchfork-pl-prs that hundred piece pv.f.ipf.hold-hab=evid

‘Now, imagine how big my grandfather’s barn was that it could fit in a hundred of such pitchforks.’

3.6.5. Non indicative forms

The 2nd person singular imperative shows either the bare root consonant or the perfective stem with a sonorant or the thematic final *-a*. Plural subject forms require the suffix *-aj* on the imperative form:

- 62) *vun kuji-žaζar kiζan ar-daj k'iba xad κaħ!*
 2 pit-obl.el hang do.pf-hort.pl little water pv.extract.imper

‘We will let you hang in the pit, scoop some water!’

63) *yala-d k'ul ʕa-b-t'in!*
 well-attr.f house(f) pv-f-build.pf

‘Have a nice mansion built!’

64) *ʕa-x-a!*
 pv-come.pf-imper

‘Come!’

65) *vin in sejl-aj sa-br-aj salamat ji-b-kin-aj.*
 2pl add eat.imper-pl imper-drink.pf.pl healthy pv-hpl-remain.pf-imper.pl

‘You too, – eat, drink and stay healthy!’

The prohibitive mood is a negative imperative, characterized by a special negative prefix *mV-* and normally based on the imperfective stem, e.g. *jert-* > *je-ma-rtu* ‘Don’t leave!’. Nevertheless, many prohibitive forms are particularly archaic and synchronically hardly analyzable, e.g. *mi* ‘Don’t do!’, *maʔu* ‘Don’t eat!’, *maʔu* ‘Don’t drink!’ (imperfective stems *ji-*, *-ul-* and *ʔik-*).

The optative is expressed by the markers *-i* (ex. a) or *-aj* (less frequent), and for the verb *xajiʒ* ‘to be’, by an irregular form (ex. 68). Thematic verbs drop the *-a* of the stem before *-i*.

66) *bazar-ʒa ʕirdalamiš ar-ʒi ugur-a-z halav va-x-i.*
 market-obl.in change do.pf-perf.q refl.m-gen-dat clothes pv-buy.pf-opt

‘Let him exchange it at the market and buy himself some clothes.’

67) *va daj va majit-ʒi-ʔ a-b-c'un-aj!*
 2.gen mother 2.gen corpse-obl-super pv-f-sit.pf-opt

‘May your mother attend your funeral!’

68) *zaʕan ječ ve-z iši!*
 1.gen+add apple 2pl.obl-dat be.opt

‘Let my apple be also for you.’

The optative marker normally attaches to a perfective stem, but imperfective optative forms are also possible:

- 69) *lu-beʕan sa-b q'wab kač' šav-ra-da-bu-m*
 this-npl.lat one.f two-f cat be.f-hab-neg-f-q
ki ʕaɤʷa k'ul-ža jert-i=vin?
 that pv.f.bring.pf(seq) house-obl.in pv.ipf.let-opt=2pl

‘Aren’t there a couple of cats around there that you could bring and let loose in the house?’

Ismailli Kryz also retains optative forms in *-a* for some verbs, with clear parallels in Budugh:

- 70) *qata-žaʕar garak saxʷar-ža ɤarč'a=vun.*
 tomorrow-obl.el must travel-obl.in pv.m.go.opt=2

‘From tomorrow you have to go on travel.’

The hortative (first person injunctive) marker is *-dam* in Alik, but just *-da* in Ismailli Kryz (in the dialect of Jek, it bears suffixal agreement):

- 71) *k'iba aɣir-da!*
 little sleep.pf-hort

‘I shall sleep a bit.’

- 72) *har sund-ur sa-d duru-ž č'al b-ažin-daj!*
 every one.obl-erg one-n false-attr.n word hpl-tell.pf-hort.pl

‘So let us each tell a lie!’

The debitive mood, based on the imperfective stem, ends in *-u* except for the verbs ‘to be’ and ‘to go’, which have irregular forms:

- 74) *ja: garak jic'-id dana jic'-id manat žerime vuc'-u=vun*
 or must ten-n piece ten-n manat penalty give.ipf-debit=2
ja: mad tažir-ži-z sa-d san havaji ištemiš šee=vun
 or more merchant-obl-dat one-n year for_free work be.debit=2

‘You shall either pay a fine of one hundred manats or spend a year working for the merchant for free.’

- 75) *a-n-ir ʕalt'un-d k'ul ši šav?*
 3-h-erg pv.ipf.f.build-attr.f house(f) what be.deb.f

‘What should a house built by her be?’

3.6.6. Non-finite forms

The verbal noun or masdar is the citation form of verbs, consisting of the perfective stem with the ending *-iž*, e.g. *ariž* ‘to do’, *xajiž* ‘to be’. The infinitive is the perfective stem with a dative case marker, e.g. *ar-iz*, *ula-z*, etc.

- 76) *ʒa-r-x-iz* *čikar* *da-d*.
pv-m-flee.pf-inf place neg.cop-n

‘There is nowhere to escape.’

Participles add attributive or case markers to bare aspectual stems, e.g. *jerxar-d* pv.pass.ipf-attr.h.nom ‘passer-by’.

- 77) *kar* *jiqir-az* *vuc'in-d*
work pv.catch.pf-inf give.ipf-attr.h.nom

‘employer’

The sequential, which in the dialect of Alik always takes the suffix *-ži*, takes in the other dialects an alternative shorter form in *-i* (*-u* for labialized root consonants) before which a final sonorant of the perfective stem is dropped:

- 78) *tažir-ži* *maʔal-a* *huš-čukur-d* *ʒa-χu*
merchant-gen nose-in conscience-pv.f.bring.ipf-attr.f pv-pour.pf(seq)
a-d *ug* *leʔux-ža* *ča-r-ku-d*.
that-h.nom ref.m blanket-obl.in pv-m-wrap-aor(m)

‘He poured some soporific into the merchant’s nose and wrapped him in the same blanket.’

At the same time, examples of the longer, probably innovative form are found in Ismaili Kryz:

- 79) *tažir* *hirstenmiš* *xaj-ži* *kačal-ži* *čiχa* *adami* *arza* *ar-d*.
merchant angry be.pf-seq bald-gen behind person send do.pf-aor.m

‘The merchant became angry and sent for the Bald Man.’

- 80) *za babaj tisbaxa-ji-κ kuʔun-(ži) mujbinži zav-a ka-č'-id.*
 1.gen grandfather turtle-obl- pv.mount.pf-(seq) seventh sky-in pv-mount.pf-
 super aor.m

'My grandfather climbed on a tortoise and flew up to the seventh layer of heaven.'

3.6.7. Complex verbs

Compound verbal predicates are also represented by compound verbs, which combine a noun and the verb 'to do' like *c'uru* (f) *v-ar-iž* 'to shout', or an adjective, or an Azeri participle, and the verbs 'to be' and 'to do', or a special "coverb", e.g. *žedir ariž* 'to hide, steal', *rafra ariž* 'to call', *harza ariž* 'to send', *rug ariž* 'to send' or *rast xajiž* 'to meet':

- 81) *κari rafra v-ar-žu.*
 woman call f-do.pf-perf.f

'He called the woman.'

- 82) *aχir-iža sij utax-ži-κ rast xaj-id.*
 end-obl.in one.obl room-obl-super meet be.pf-aor(m)

'In the end, he reached a room.'

- 83) *jazuχ-ža sil-iž sa-d xu-ji-r rug ar-ž.*
 pitiable-obl.gen teeth-gen one-n bread-obl-erg break do.pf-aor.n

'The bread broke one of the poor thing's teeth.'

Some of these coverbs are frozen forms corresponding to operative verbs in the other dialects, e.g. *q'ajr ariž* 'to kill' < 'make die', *kin xajiž* 'to spread'. Some coverbs often still bear gender agreement, e.g. *dixar ariž* / *duxar v-ariž* 'to make', (v)-*ac'ar xajiž* 'to know', *kandir kiχ'an v-ariž* 'to let a rope (f) hang':

- 84) *tažir-ži-r vuj-i-ž κabiz in hudk'ar ar-ž.*
 merchant-obl-erg give.pf-ptcp-obl.nh signature add pv.n.show do.pf-aor.n

'He showed him the bond the merchant had given him.'

- 85) *ugur-a aji-ž xu κikar ar-ž tažir-ža gada q'ale-κar.*
 refl.m-gen dry-attr.n bread touch do.pf-aor.n merchant-obl.in boy(gen) head.obl-inel

'He whacked the child on the head with the stale bread he had in his hands.'

Azeri verbs are actively borrowed using compounding constructions, usually in their perfect participle form ending in *-mİš* (ex.), but also (in the Ismaili dialect) as bare stems (ex.):

- 86) *dunmuš* *sax!*
 dress imper.be

‘Wear it!’

- 87) *sa-b* *kalak* *kurmiš* *v-ar!*
 one-f ruse(f) set f-do.pf(imper)

‘You should think of a trick.’

- 88) *ahmad-ir* *kač’* *k’ul-žə* *buraχ* *v-ar-du*
 A.-erg cat house-obl.in leave f-do.pf-aor.f

‘Ahmed left the cat at home.’ cf. Az. *buraxmaq* ‘to leave’

Many of these verbs can switch valency. For this purpose, it is not enough for them to simply change their auxiliary; the borrowed participle retains its original Azeri causative or anticausative markers, e.g. *diri-l-miš xəjiž* [***add glosses] ‘to be revived’ / *diri-l-t-miš ariž* [***add glosses] ‘to revive’:

- 89) *daha* *c’ir-iκ* *sa-b* *κazanča* *xad* *κi-ja* *κajnatmiš* *ar-ž.*
 quickly fire.obl-super one-f pot water pv-n.beat.pf boil.caus do.pf-aor.n

‘The Bald Man quickly filled a pot with water and boiled it.’

Ismaili Kryz, like the other dialects, has instances of coverb formations combining a Kryz lexeme and an Azeri derivative suffix plus *-mİš*, e.g. *miq’əκ-laš-miš* [***add glosses] ‘getting near’.

3.7. Adverbs and postpositions

3.7.1. Local adverbs and postpositions

Apart from unanalyzable words like *iχta* ‘far’ or *miq’əκ* ‘near’, the roots forming preverbs and case markers are also found on locative adverbs, e.g. *ƣaran ƣa-č’id* ‘He went in.’, *ƣuran κabč’udu* ‘She moved forward.’, as well as demonstratives inflected for a spatial case:

- 90) *ud* *lu-ž-a* *am* *lam-a.*

3.nn.nom this-nh.obl-in that that2-in

‘this here, that there’

Kryz also has spatial postpositions, some of which are dialect-specific. They usually follow a noun phrase in the genitive, e.g. *taḡta-ji ʕadiḡ* ‘on a board’, *za čix̣a* ‘behind me’. Ismaili Kryz, more than the other dialects, tends to replace obsolete locative cases by spatial nouns inflected for case and used as postpositions. Borrowed from Azeri are *haḡḡina* ‘about’ and *jan-ža* [side-OBL.IN] ‘near’. The most frequent ones are *q’an* ‘bottom’ > ‘under’, *ʕadi* ‘surface’ > ‘on’, *q’i* ‘inside’, *ʕur* ‘front’:

- 91) *vuraḡ-ži* *q’an-ik* *gaši-d* *tašna* *ištamiš* *še-reni*.
 sun-gen bottom-sub hunger-attr.m thirst work be.ipf-imperf

‘He worked all day long under the burning sun without food or water.’

- 92) *maḡara-ji* *q’i-ji-z* *aḡḡejti* *jixir-d* *ki...*
 cave-gen inside-obl-dat so_much pv-go.pf-aor(m) that

‘He walked such a long way inside the cave...’

- 93) *luč’a-ž* *hamam-ži* *q’i-ža*
 old-attr.n bath-gen inside-obl.in

‘in the old hammam’

- 94) *ḡapu-j* *ʕur-a* *sa-b* *q’usu-d* *mundara-d* *a-b-c’un-žav*.
 door-gen front-in one-f old-attr.f dirty-attr.f pv-f-sit.pf-perf.f

‘An old witch was sitting by the door.’

The word for ‘with’ (instrumental or comitative) is *q’an* in Jek and Kryz proper, *zina* in Alik, but *q’ina* in Ismaili, following a genitive, e.g. *pulibe q’ina* [money-PL.GEN WITH] ‘with the money’;

- 95) *kačal* *igir-a* *badaj-a* *q’ina* *saḡullašmiš* *xaj-id*.
 bald refl.pl-gen grandmother-gen with salute be.pf-aor(m)

‘The Bald Man said goodbye to his grandmother.’

3.7.2. Temporal adverbs and postpositions

Temporal deixis makes use of spatial adverbs such as *ǰura(n)* ‘before’ < ‘in front’, *halaǰa* ‘then’ < ‘there’, and synchronically unanalyzable lexemes such as *ke* ‘today’, *qata* ‘tomorrow’, *naq* ‘yesterday’, *hisan* ‘now’, *ǰiǰan* ‘later’, including loans like *daha* ‘soon’ and *ǰuxdan* ‘long ago’:

- 96) *ǰura* *xu* *vuc'in-e=vin* *na* *ǰiǰan* *q'ajr* *b-ir-e=vin*
 before bread give.ipf-prs=2pl and then die.ipf hpl-do.ipf-prs2pl

‘First you feed and then you kill (us).’

- 97) *karvan* *ǰuxdan* *jit-iǰeni*.
 caravan long_ago n.pass.pf-pqpf

‘The caravan had passed long ago.’

The postposition *majin* ‘until’, only found in Ismaili Kryz, follows a form in the locative:

- 98) *taǰir-ǰi-r* *qata-ǰa* *majin* *vaxt* *ikʷa* *xʷaj-du*.
 merchant-obl-erg tomorrow-obl.in until time want.f be.f.pf-aor.f

‘The merchant requested a deferral till the day after.’

3.7.3. Manner adverbs

When answering the question ‘how?’ (*hal(u)ma* in Ismaili Kryz), some adjectives can take the Azeri suffix *-ǰa*, e.g. *sakit-ǰa* ‘quiet-ly’ or form a noun phrase headed by the equally borrowed noun *tahar* ‘manner’.

3.8. Particles

The additive particle has the form *in* in Ismaili Kryz (*an* in the other dialects):

-) *kač'=in* *ugura* *q'ina* *ǰaǰa-ǰa-v-ni*.
 cat=add m.refl.gen with pv.bring.pf-perf-f-pst

‘He add also brought the cat with him.’

In negative context, it is emphasized by the borrowed particle *heč* ‘at all’:

-) *heč* *za-z=in* *ac'ar-a-da-d*.
 at_all 1.obl-dat=add know-hab-neg-n

‘I do not know myself.’

) *ħu-ž* *dahar-bi* *jiji-b=in* *su-t'-už* *div-ne* *q'ali-κ*.
 mill-gen stone-pl.nom seven-f=add pv-push_down.pf-aor.n ogre-pl.gen head.obl-super
 'He pushed all the seven mill stones down on the ogres' heads.'

A defective matrix verb found in Alik under the present form *mažan-e (ki)* 'think(s) (that)' corresponds in Ismaili to the isolated particle-like form *maža*, which can be followed directly by a finite form:

) *ige-z* *maža* *unda-z* *igeb*
 refl.hpl.obl-dat seem 3.hpl.gen-dat refl.hpl.nom
q'ajr *b-ar-iž* *b-ika-že-b*.
 die.ipf hpl-do.pf-msd hpl-want-perf-hpl
 'They thought that they wanted to kill them.'

) *tažir-ži-z* *maža* *kačal* *q'aj-id*.
 merchant-obl-dat seem bald die.pf-aor(m)
 'The merchant thought that the Bald Man was dead.'

4. Syntax

Gender-number agreement with S/P (Single argument or Patient) is prefixed to the root of synthetic verbs. Person is mainly expressed by free pronouns, which can be repeated as a clitic after the verb. Word order is head-final (possessor-possessed, adjective-noun, and Agent-Patient-Verb as the basic order); case marking and cross-referencing on the verb are ergative.

4.1. Noun phrases

The order of elements in the noun phrase is head-final, with numerals before adjectives before relative clauses.

In Ismaili and Haput Kryz, adjectives and other attributes except numerals take nominative vs. oblique form depending on the case of the head and agree in gender-number only in the masculine and feminine singular:

Table.

(head)	M & F	N & PL
NOM	-d	
OBL		-ž

) *q'usi-ž sij kari-κ luku-d diχ je-ni.*
 old-attr.n one.obl woman-super limp-attr.m son cop.m-pst

‘An old woman had a disabled son.’

) *luzu-ž duman-ži q'i-žašar muji-b luzu-d div ka-b-č'-udu.*
 white-attr.obl fog-gen inside-obl.el eight-f white-attr.f ogre(f) pv-f-go_out.pf-aor.f

‘Seven white ogres appeared out of a white cloud.’

) *taza-ž k'ul-ža*
 new-attr.obl house-obl.in

‘In his new house’

) *aji-ž xu-jni*
 dry-attr.npl bread-pl.nom

‘stale pieces of bread’

) *div-ne bejli-ž šij-ir lar...*
 ogre-pl.gen big-attr.obl brother.obl-erg said

‘The eldest of the ogre brothers said...’

Note that many speakers of the Ismaili dialect do not consistently apply agreement to modifiers, as can be seen in the following example, in which oblique agreement with the head fails to be observed (*sij* should be used instead of *sa-r*, and *luku-ž*, *bili-ž* instead of *luku-d*, *bili-d*):

) *riχ-a sa-r kil-li luku-d sa-b ūl bili-d kari-κ*
 road-in one-f leg-with limp-attr.f one-f eye(f) blind-attr.f old_woman-super
rast šaxir-d.
 meet pv.come.pf-aor.m

‘On his way he met a woman who was limp of a leg and blind of an eye.’

4.2. Clause structure and verb valencies

Basic grammatical relations are organized according to an ergative/nominative case marking system with gender-number cross-referencing of the single or patientive (S/P) core argument on the verb. Nouns expressing S and P are in the unmarked “nominative” case.

Agents are in the ergative case (except for SAP pronouns which do not have the ergative/nominative distinction, so for them the ordering – A preceding P – is relevant):

-) *kačal-ži-r jiji-d jiɤ jiji-d jux midx^war ar-ž.*
 bald-obl-erg seven-n day seven-n night wedding do.pf-aor.n

‘The Bald Man celebrated the wedding for seven days and seven nights.’

-) *garak kačal zin q’ajr-i.*
 must bald 1.nom die.ipf-opt

‘I must kill the Bald Man myself.’

Recoverable or irrelevant agents are often left out:

-) *kač’ mazar vuc’un-eni.*
 cat sell give.f.ipf-imperf

‘They were selling a cat / A cat was being sold.’

-) *suxra čuk’ni-ž xin-a-ž ɬadiɤ kevɬa-du.*
 tablecloth(f) green-attr.obl grass-obl-attr.obl on pv.f.spread.pf-aor.f

‘(S/he) spread the tablecloth on green grass.’

In the dialect of Ismailli only, the ergative can be used with the adjective ‘full’:

-) *utaɤ-ar ɤaš-daš-in-ir ɬac’=e-ni.*
 room-pl gems-obl-erg full=cop-pst

‘The rooms were full of gems.’

...and with body-related nouns: *tapuk-ži-r, χid-in-ir* ‘with kicks and punches’:

-) *gaši-ji-r riq’ar-že.*
 hunger-obl-erg ipf.die-fut

‘He is going to starve.’

-) *ahmad sij yirxin-ir ɤe-t’-id.*
 A. one.obl heat-erg pv-strike.pf-aor(m)

‘Ahmed had a heat stroke.’

Contact verbs treat the instrument or body part as a direct object, while the goal takes a spatial case:

-) *tandir-i* *suju-κ* *sa-b* *bejli-d* *ħu-d* *dahar* *κi-va-d-u*.
oven-gen mouth.obl-super one-f big-attr.f mill-attr.f stone(f) pv-f.put_on.pf-aor-f

‘(He) covered it with a big millstone.’

Monovalent intransitive verbs have their argument in the nominative case:

-) *tažir* *aχir-že*.
merchant sleep.pf-perf

‘The merchant is asleep.’

Some verbs like *uχriž* ‘to study’ and *ažniž* ‘to tell’ show mixed behaviour in Ismaili Kryz, agreeing in gender with their ergative argument:

-) *jeddinži* *sinix^w-ža* *uχu-ra-v* *an-ir*.
seventh class-obl.in study-hab-f that.h-erg

‘She studies in seventh grade.’

-) *kačal-žir* *uga* *q’ali-κ* *vaxir-bi*
bald-obl.erg refl.gen head.obl-super pv.happen.pf-pl.nom
igira *badaj-iz* *ažin-d*.
refl.pl.gen grandmother-dat tell.pf-aor.m

‘The Bald Man told his grandmother about his adventures.’

Predicates of perception have a stimulus in the nominative case and an experiencer in the dative case:

-) *kačal-ži-z* *χajli* *gaši* *χaj-ižini*.
bald-obl-dat very hunger be.pf-perf.pst

‘The Bald Man had grown very hungry.’

) *a-n-iz* *adamij-ar* *i-b-q-a* *žedir* *xaj-id.*
 3-obl.h-dat person-pl pv-f-look-pf(seq) hide be.pf-aor(m)

‘The Bald Man saw the merchant’s men approaching and hid.’

Recipients of ditransitive verbs are in the dative case, or in the adressive case if property transfer is irrelevant.

) *a-ni-r* *pul-ibi* *iger-a* *badaj-van* *vuj-iž.*
 3-obl.h-erg money-pl.nom hpl.refl-gen grandmother-adr give.pf-aor.n

‘He brought the money to his grandmother.’

The dative, adressive and adelative cases mark arguments of speech verbs:

) *xaj-bi* *ugur-a* *ež-iz* / *ež-van* *ažin-d.*
 be.pf-npl.nom refl.m-gen wife-dat wife-adr tell.pf-aor(m)

‘He told the story to his wife.’

) *zuva-var* *sa-d* *č'al* *χukur-že* *zin.*
 1+2.obl-adel one-n word ask.ipf-fut 1.nom

‘I will ask you something.’

The adelative is governed by verbs like *kišxajiž* ‘to fear’, *χukajž* ‘to ask’, *ika xajiž* ‘to ask for’ and other expression like *januxli xajiž* ‘to be angry’ or *visas vajniž* ‘to take revenge’.

4.3. Valence-change: the potential and causative constructions

Instances of verbal lability are found in Kryz, for which see Authier (2009) on the dialect of Alik. Our Ismaili Kryz data do not allow for a precise account here.

The potential construction uses the verb *xajiž* ‘to be’ as ‘to be able’, with a lexical verb heading the infinitival clause. While the other dialects use the adelative case for subjects in such constructions, in Ismaili Kryz the case of the subject remains unchanged and is only determined by the lexical verb:

) *tažir* *kačal-ža* *q'ina* *bažarmiš* *ar-az* *dašxar-že.*
 merchant bald-obl.in with manage do.pf-inf neg.be.ipf-fut

‘He / merchant? will not be able to cope with the Bald Man any longer.’

) *kačal-žī-r ug-ur=un aqa-z daxa.*
 bald-obl-erg ref.m-erg=add pv.hold.pf-inf neg.be.pf(aor)

‘The Bald Man could not take it any longer.’

Causative constructions use the verb *ariž* ‘to make’ as an auxiliary and apply it only to intransitive verbs, which appear as a special (neither perfective nor imperfective), suffixless form:

) *zina-z sa-b yala-d riš va-b-q^war ir-žav=zin.*
 1.refl-dat one-f good-attr.f girl pv-f-find do.ipf-perf.f=1.nom

‘I am going on a journey and I shall find myself a nice girl.’

A causative form can show up without any agent in the ergative case in the perfect, with resultative meaning:

) *luža sa-b šajara-d riš iž-a mičⁱ-jar-var ki-χ^wan v-ar-žu.*
 here one-f good-attr.f girl refl.f-gen plait-pl-adel pv-hang.f f-do.pf-perf.f

‘There was a beautiful maiden hanging (lit. hung) by her hair.’

To add an agent to a transitive construction, the only way in Kryz is to derank it as an infinitive depending of the verb ‘give’:

) *k’ul halma šabt’in-az vuj-iji-ka^r*
 house(f) how pv.f.build.pf-inf give.pf-msd.obl-superel
ug-uz ixtilat var-du.
 m.refl-dat story f.do.pf-aor.f

‘(She) told him how she had the house built.’

The Kryz dialect of Alik has developed a widely used detransitive “medio-passive” voice, which is not attested in our Ismaili corpus nor in other dialects.

4.3. Interrogative and exclamative clauses

Dedicated interrogative verb forms ending in *-i* (replacing any final gender marker) are the rule in the dialect of Alik, but only possible, not obligatory in Ismaili Kryz:

) *ši kazanǰ ar-ǰi vun?*
 what salary do.pf-perf.q=2

‘What did you earn?’

) *va-~~h~~ hal-ir ~~h~~ija-ǰ?*
 2.obl-super who.obl-erg pv.beat.pf-aor.n

‘Who hit you?’

As in standard Azeri, global questions in Ismaili Kryz are marked by rising intonation usually without the borrowed suffix *-m* found in the other dialects, for which see Authier (2010c):

) *zin=in vuna q’ina čik-ira=vun?*
 1.nom=add 2.refl.gen with pv.bring.ipf-hab=2

‘Will you take me with you?’

4.4. Complex sentences

Relative and adverbial clauses are mainly of the non-finite type while complement clauses can be both finite and non-finite. Intensive (emphatic) third person pronouns are used for reflexivity across clauses, including logophoricity, and serve to disambiguate coreference:

) *ige-r at-a-d taǰir ug=e.*
 rel.pl.obl-erg beat-pf-attr.m merchant ref.m=cop.m

‘The one they were beating was the merchant himself.’

) *ige-z maǰa unda-z*
 refl.hpl.obl-dat seem 3.hpl.obl-dat
igeb q’ajr b-ar-iǰ b-ika-ǰeb.
 refl.hpl.nom die hpl-do.pf-msd hpl-want-perf.hpl

‘They_i thought that they_j wanted to kill them_i.’

4.4.1. Relative clauses

Attributive relative clauses use participles. Monosyllabic roots like *xajiǰ* ‘become’, or *vujiǰ* ‘give’ add *-ji* before the attributive marker:

) *dünja irqa-d q'usu-d xuri je-ni.*
 world pv.m.see.pf-attr.m old-attr.m man cop.m-pst

‘He was an experienced (lit. who has seen the world) old man.’

) *sij hax^wta-žafar jidkin-ž xu-ji kirχ-imi*
 one.obl week-obl.el pv.n.remain.pf-attr.obl bread-gen crumb-pl.nom

‘pieces of one-week-old (lit. which stayed for a week) bread’

) *u-d vun luʔur-ž kačal-be-kir da-r.*
 3-m.nom 2 say.ipf-attr.obl bald-pl.obl-part neg.cop-m

‘This is not the ordinary kind of bald man you think (lit. what you say) he is.’

) *kačal-ži-r vu-ji-ž pul-ibe q'ina*
 bald-obl-erg give.pf-ptcp-obl.npl money-pl.gen with

‘with the money the Bald Man had given (her)’

In headless, substantivized relative clauses, the participle must inflect for gender-number and case:

) *jibkin-d za-z vat-aj!*
 pv.hpl.remain.pf-attr.f 1.obl-dat give.imper-pl

‘Give me the rest.’

) *lu kar-ibi ir-ž bulaχ-ži xad=e.*
 this work-pl do.ipf-subst.nom.n spring-gen water=cop

‘It is the water of the source which is doing this.’

) *kačal-ži-r xaj-bi darva-ji-z ažin-d.*
 bald-obl-erg be.pf-npl judge-obl-dat tell.pf-aor(m)

‘The Bald Man told the story (lit. what happened) to the village judge.’

) *ug-a ižin-a ik-i-n-ir luʔur-ani ki samaždina ika-da!*
 refl.m-gen face-in look-ptcp-h.obl-erg say.ipf-irreal that again want-hort

‘Who would look at his face would say ‘Let’s look again!’.’

Finite relative clause using a interrogative word are attested but rare, mainly with non verbal predicates:

-) *halži-d* *xejli=jav* *vin* *ɛvajn-aj!*
 which-attr.f much=cop.f 2pl take.f.imper=pl

‘Take yourself what there is plenty of.’

In indefinite relative clauses, Kryz may use the Azeri conditional marker *-sa* as a clitic instead of the indigenous conditional form ending in *-na*:

-) *halži-ž* *va-z* *xaqir=je-sa* *hala-ž* *sečmiš* *ar!*
 which-attr.n 2.obl-dat interest=cop.n-cond that-n choose do.pf

‘You shall choose what you think is best.’

4.4.2. Complementation

Short complement clauses tend to nominalize their predicate in the masdar form, as an object in the nominative with verbs like ‘to begin’ (ex. a)

-) *baštatmiš* *ar-iž* *zuma-ž.*
 start do.pf-aor.n wash.pf-msd

‘He started the washing.’

The verb ‘to want’ bears long-distance agreement:

-) *ja-z* *vin* *q’ajr* *b-ar-iž* *b-ika-da-bu.*
 1pl.obl-dat 2pl die hpl-do.pf-msd hpl-want-neg-hpl

‘We do not want to kill you.’

-) *ahmad-iz* *mad* *jixir-iž* *ika* *daxa.*
 A.-dat again go.pf-msd want neg.be.aor

‘Again Ahmed refused to go.’

as an adjunct (in the adelative case expressing cause)

) *tažir* *kačal* *ata-j-var* *šalkin-ženi*.
 merchant bald beat.pf-ptcp-adel pv.m.be_tired.pf-perf.pst

‘The merchant had worn himself down beating the Bald Man.’

or in the genitive with a postposition:

) [*žedir* *xaj-iji* *q’ina*] *ugur-a* *žan* *azar* *ar-az* *da-šxar-že*.
 hide be.pf-msd.gen with ref.ml-gen life save do.pf-inf neg-be.ipf-fut

‘The Bald Man realised that he could not save himself by hiding.’

Indirect interrogative clauses include a question word and can be non-finite, with a masdar, but longer complement clauses tend to be finite, with indicative or other moods, and often start with the borrowed clitic *ki*:

) *ahmad-iz* *ika* *xaj-iž* *šarxa*.
 A.-dat want be.pf-aor.n pv.m.flee.opt

‘Ahmed wanted to flee.’

) *i-rqar-ada-d* *va-z* *kačal-ži-r* *sil* *rug* *xaj-ži* *išar-e?*
 pv-see.ipf-hab.neg.n 2.obl-dat bald-obl-erg tooth break be.pf-seq cry.ipf-prs

‘Can you not see that the Bald Man has broken a tooth and is crying?’

) *za-z* *ika-že=ki* *vun* *k’iba* *pul* *ʁazanž* *iju=vun*.
 1.obl-dat want-perf=that 2 little money salary do.debit=2

‘I want you to earn some money.’

) *irqa-že=va-z=ki* *dava-ji* *karvan-bi* *čer-e*.
 pv.see.ipf-fut=2.obl-dat=that camel-gen caravan-pl go.ipf-prs

‘You will see a caravan of camels passing.’

Complement clauses of perception verbs may also use participles:

) *a-n-ir* *ug-a* *gada* *šaxir-d* *irqa-d* *na* *lar...*
 3-obl.h-erg refl.m-gen boy pv.come.pf-attr.m pv.m.look.pf-attr.m and say

‘The merchant saw his son who had arrived and asked.’

Reported speech also uses finite clauses:

-) *yala lip-iže div-ni aχmaq' še-re.*
well say.pf-perf ogre-pl.nom stupid be.ipf-prs

‘It is not for nothing that they say ogres are foolish.’

-) *tažir-ži-van lup za juz tuman vuj-i.*
merchant-obl-adr say.pf 1.gen hundred toman give.pf-opt

‘Tell the merchant to give me my one hundred tumans!’

It can be followed by the quotative particle *va* or introduced by the complementizer *ki*:

-) *tažir-ža adamij-ar-ir χabar tu-κ-a-ž ki kačal ζa-r-xu-že.*
merchant-obl.in person-pl-erg news pv-carry-pf-aor.n that bald pv-m-flee.pf-perf

‘The merchant’s men reported that the Bald Man had fled.’

-) *tažir-ža adamij-ar-iz javaš-ža pičildamiš xaj-id ki bičaj*
merchant-obl.in person-pl-dat quiet-adv whisper be.pf-aor(m) that hpl.go.pl
kačal q’aj-izkara at-aj.
bald die.pf-until beat-imper.pl

‘He whispered to the merchant’s men telling them to go and beat the Bald Man to death.’

4.4.3. Adverbial clauses

Most adverbial clauses use special non finite or non indicative verb forms.

4.4.3.1. Manner clauses

The sequential, positive or negative, often conveys the manner in which the action is performed:

-) *a-n-ir qare jiq’-žafar sa-b tapuk κi-v-a*
3-h-erg old_woman.in back-obl.el one-f kick(f) pv-f.put_on.pf
a-b-cuζa-d-u tandir-a.
pv-f-drop.pf-aor-f oven-in

‘He gave the old woman a kick in the back pushing her into the oven.’

-) *ǝajal-ǝi-r* *eǝ-a* *č'al* *ugur-a* *veǝ-in-a* *ka-da-jn-i*
 child-obl-erg wife-gen word refl.m-gen care-obl-in pv-neg-take.pf-seq
anǝak *hala* *mahni* *uǝa-ǝ.*
 only that_same song sing.pf-aor.n

‘Without paying any attention to the woman’s words, the child continued to sing his little song.’

The simple imperfective converb in *-a* also conveys manner:

-) *pišuk-ǝu* *ku-lq'an-a* *kum-a* *ǝa-rxar-a.*
 pussy-obl.super pv-ipf.mount-hab village-in pv-ipf.flee-hab

‘He mounts a cat, and he runs to the village *or* Mounting a cat, he runs to the village.’

-) *surunmiš* *še-ra* *ǝaxir-d* *suxra-ǝi* *kirax-ǝa.*
 crawl be.ipf-hab pv.come.pf-aor.m table-gen side-obl.in

‘He came near the table crawling.’

Parallel to the reduplicated Azeri forms in *-A*, if this imperfective converb is reduplicated, it acquires an affective, intensive nuance, e.g. *irǝ tuǝar-a tuǝar-a* ‘covered in blood’:

-) *išar-a* *išar-a* *ǝa-r-xu-d* *ige* *baj-a* *jan-ǝa.*
 cry.ipf-manner cry.ipf-manner pv-m-flee.pf-aor(m) refl.hpl.gen father-gen side-obl.in

‘He ran back to his father all in tears.’

-) *riš-ir* *jix-i* *surt'-ura-* *sut'-ura*
 girl-erg go.pf-seq pv.ipf.push-manner pv.push_down.pf-manner
sad *tahar* *k'ul-ǝaǝar* *kaqir-d.*
 one.n manner house-obl.el pv.take_out.pf-aor.m

‘The girl went on pushing him and finally managed to push him out.’

Note that with a light verb construction, only the light verb is repeated:

-) *kar-r* *c'uru* *ir-a* *ir-a* *ug-a* *raq* *x'aj-d-u.*
 old_woman-erg shout(f) do.ipf-manner do.ipf-manner burn-pf ashes be.f.pf-aor-f

‘The old woman screamed loudly as she burned to ashes.’

4.4.3.2. Purpose and causal clauses

Same subject purpose clauses use the infinitive, a dative marked perfective form:

-) *ve* *daj* *ji-p-udu* *bulaκ-ži-κar* *xad* *ζa-κ-a-z.*
2pl.gen mother pv-f.go.pf-aor.f spring-obl-superel water pv-bring-pf-inf

‘Your mother went to fetch water from the source.’

Longer same-subject and different-subject purpose clauses ones feature a non-indicative mood (hortative, imperative, optative) depending in the person of the subject in the purpose clause:

-) *ad* *raζra* *ar-d=ki* *κuzu* *ζaxir-i* *xu* *ul-az.*
3.nom call do.pf-aor.m=that pv.stand_up.seq pv.come.pf-opt bread eat.ipf-inf

‘She called him so that he would get up and come to eat.’

-) *κari-r* *tandir-a* *c’a* *a-b-saζ-ud-u=ki* *kačal* *c’ir-a* *žir-i.*
old_woman-erg oven-in fire pv-f-light.pf-aor-f=that bald fire.obl-in cook-opt

‘The woman heated the oven so that she could roast the Bald Man.’

-) *a-n-ir* *za-z* *vasi* *ar-ženi* *ki* *zin* *ug* *zuma-da.*
3-h-erg 1-dat will do.pf-pqpf that 1.nom m.refl wash.pf-hort

‘He bequeathed that I should cleanse his body.’

-) *a-n-ir* *xad* *ζa-šxu-nani* *ki* *sa-d* *k’iba* *jumšalmiš* *iši.*
that-h-erg water pv-ipf.pour-hab.pst that one-n little soften be.opt

‘She would place the old bread in a pot and pour water over it, so that it became a bit softer.’

Note the construction meaning ‘almost do something’:

-) *k’iba* *jidkin-ž* *uga* *jik’* *para* *iši.*
little pv.n.remain.pf-aor.n refl.m.gen heart split be.opt

‘His heart almost burst.’

The quotative particle *va* is also used with causal meaning:

) *sadna tažir-ži-r darba-jiz χuruz ʕa-ɸ^wa-ženi va*
 once merchant-obl-erg judge-dat rooster pv-f.bring.pf-perf.pst quot
baštamiš ar-ž mad in χuruz-ži-ɸar ažin-iž.
 start do.pf-aor.n more add rooster-obl-superel tell.pf-msd

‘As the merchant had already bribed the village elder with a rooster once, he started bringing up a rooster in the conversation again.’

4.4.3.2. Temporal clauses

Temporal clauses add special postposed conjunctions cliticized to non-finite verb forms. All of them are specific to the Ismaili dialect. The main ones are *xala* (with a masdar form of the verb to denote a punctual time, or to a present or habitual form with the meaning ‘while’):

) *bašmaɸ-ar adami-ji-r ugura ɸil-iɸ ɸita-ž xala...*
 shoe-pl people-obl-erg m.refl.gen leg-super pv.put_on.pf-msd when

‘When / as soon as one puts the shoes on...’

) *kačal-žir q'im šumlamiš ir-e xala...*
 bald-obl.erg ground plough do.ipf-prs after

‘while the Bald was ploughing...’

samad ‘as soon as’ (after a masdar in the genitive case):

) *a-d ɸileʕin ɸu-zur-iji samad šikajat-ža jixir-d.*
 3-h.nom foot.in+add pv-stand_up.pf-msd.gen as complaint-obl.in go.pf-aor.m

‘As soon as he was back on his feet, he went to complain.’

čin (after imperfective stems) / *ma* ‘before’ (after a negative sequential form) meaning ‘before’:

) *a-žib ʕa-bi-šxar čin zivun žira-da!*
 that-hpl pv-hpl-come.ipf before 1+2 fry.pf-hort

‘Before they arrive I shall have you cooked and ready.’

) *xu deli ma q'ajr b-ar-aj!*
 bread neg.eat.seq before die hpl-do.pf-imper.pl

‘Kill (us) before we have eaten!’

and *len* ‘after’ (with an inelative form of the masdar):

-) *vin* *jixir-žer* *len* *va* *ež-ir* *šabt’un-žav*.
 2pl go.pf-msd.inel after 2.gen wife-erg pv.f.build.pf-perf.f
 ‘After your departure, your wife built it.’

The fact that all these converb-like analytic forms are not found in the other dialects suggests that this type of adverbial verb forms are recent and as prone to renewal as clause-initial conjunctions (Meillet 1912).

4.4.3.3. Conditional clauses

Conditional forms add *-na* (or also *-nam* in Ismaili Kryz) to the perfective verb stem. The protasis can start with the particle *agar*, borrowed from Azeri:

-) *šac’in* *da-b-xa-na=vin* *zašan* *ječ* *ve-z* *iši!*
 satiated neg-hpl-be-cond-2pl 1.gen+add apple 2pl.obl-dat be.opt
 ‘If you are not satiated, let my apple be for you.’

-) *agar* *ve-z* *kar* *ar-anam* *jaxi-jar-iz=in* *kar* *ir-a*.
 if 2pl.obl-dat work do.pf-cond enemy-pl-dat=add work do.ipf-hab
 ‘If it works on you, it will work on your enemies, too.’

In Ismaili Kryz, a condition presented as a reality in the future can use the Azeri clitic *=sa* added to the future tense form, after any personal clitic:

-) *agar* *jin* *q’ajr* *bir-že=vin=sa...*
 if 1pl die.ipf hpl.do.ipf-fut=2pl=cond
 ‘If you are going to kill us...’

In Ismaili Kryz, counterfactual conditions add to a masdar the suffix *-q’wajnim*, of unclear origin:

-) *zin* *ša-da-xir-ž* *q’wajnim=zin* *adami* *q’aj-ži* *čer-ženi*.
 1 pv-neg-come.pf-msd counterfact=1 person die.pf-perf.q go.ipf-irreal
 ‘Had I not come, the merchant would have been dead.’

Concessive clauses have the ending =*nan* (< -*na* + additive particle (*i*)*n*):

-) *a-n-ir* *va-var* *ši* *χuk-a-nan* *am* *duza-ž* *lup!*
 that.obl-h-erg 2.obl-adel what ask-pf-cond that true-attr.n say.pf(imper)

‘Whatever he says, tell the truth.’

4.4.5. Comparative constructions

Kryz has denominal adjectives of comparison bearing the suffix -*vana* (built on the obsolete comparative case marker -*kan*, found in the dialect of Alik):

-) *siĵ* *maḡara-j-vana-ž* *čikar* *e.*
 one.obl cave-gen-like-attr.n place cop

‘There is a place like a cave.’

Nouns depending of the word *suxun* ‘like’ (maybe a loan from Persian meaning ‘word’) also form adverbial expressions:

-) *ʕajal-ža* *q'il* *ḡarpuz-ži* *suxun* *parttamiš* *xʷaj-du.*
 child-obl.in head(f) watermelon-adv like explode be.f.pf-aor.f

‘The child’s head busted open like a watermelon.’

-) *ahmad-ir* *riš-ir* *luḡur-ži* *suxun* *ar-ž.*
 A.-erg daughter-erg say.ipf-gen like do.pf-aor.n

‘Ahmed did as the girl was saying.’

The quotative particle *va*: also can have a comparative meaning (‘as if’):

-) *darḡa-ji-r* *kačal-ži* *jan-ža* *ug-uḡ* *sir* *ja-v-ni* *va:* *tažir-ži-z*
 judge-obl-erg bald-gen side-obl.in ref.m-super tomb cop-f-pst quote merchant-obl-dat
 ugur-a *q'il* *ʕa-b-č'ur* *v-ar-du.*
 refl.m-gen head(f) pv-f-lower f-do.pf-aor.f

‘The village elder, having a secret to hide from the Bald Man, tilted his head towards the merchant.’

Finally, consecutive clauses take the complementizer *ki*, with a comparative adverb in the main clause:

) *luma t'arhar-e ki buš in aji-κ surq 'war-dab*
 so pv.ipf.run-prs that bird add that.obl-super pv.ipf.reach-neg.f

'He can run so fast that even a bird could not catch up with him.'

4.4.6. Coordination, clause-chaining

Noun phrase coordination

Disjunct coordination requires the Azeri particle *ja*:

Parataxis of finite predicates is allowed in Ismaili Kryz:

) *kačal q'im-uκ ζa-q'in-d i-d-q-a-ž=ki*
 bald ground-super pv-go_down.pf-aor(m) pv-n.see-pf-aor.n=that

'The Bald Man came down from the roof and saw that...'

At the same time, instances of the noun phrase coordinator *na* are found to link predicates:

) *ζaq'in-d na kandir ugura jiq'-ži-κar ačmiš v-ar-du.*
 pv.go_down.pf-aor.m and rope m.refl.gen waist-obl- open f-do.pf-aor-f
 superel

'He went down and untied the rope from this waist.'

Still, clause-chaining using sequential forms is the main device for the coordination of predicates sharing the same subject and depictive predicates. The case of the shared subject can be determined by the verb in the sequential:

) *har sund-ur sa-b čut bašmaκ ki-t-a ji-p-ižib.*
 every one.h-erg one-f pair shoe pv-put_on-pf(seq) pv-hpl.go.pf-aor.hpl

'Each of them put on a pair of shoes, and off they went.'

Verbs in the sequential are within the scope of the first non-sequential form to follow:

) *jix-i garak ištamiš šee=vun.*
 go.pf-seq must work be.ipf.deb=2

‘You have to go and work.’

) *qata* *kačal* *ša-x-i* *pul* *ika* *xaj-nan...*
 tomorrow bald pv-come.pf-seq money want be.pf-cond

‘If the Bald Man comes tomorrow asking for money’

) *div-in-ir* *ahmad* *q’ajr* *d-ar-i* *buraχ* *ar-d.*
 devil-obl-erg A. die neg-do.pf-seq leave do.pf-aor.m

‘The devil left Ahmed without killing him.’

4.8. Non-verbal predication

The Kryz dialect of Ismaili has completely lost the rich system of spatial copulas still alive in the mountain dialects. Nominal, adjectival and existential predicates in Kryz use a form of either the copula or the verb ‘to be’. The copula in Ismaili does not seem to make a clear distinction between forms denoting identification (Alik *-(j)e*) and existential value (Alik *jač*), *but* in Ismaili, a rhotic realization is occasionally found for the later use: *jer*, *jor*, or *je* instead of *-e* after a consonant. Below is the paradigm of the copula in Ismaili Kryz:

Table.

	non-existential	existential	negative forms
M	= <i>(j)e</i>	<i>je</i>	<i>da-r</i>
F	= <i>(j)av</i>	<i>jav</i>	<i>da-b(u)</i>
	= <i>(j)e</i>	<i>je</i>	<i>da-d</i>
HPL	= <i>(j)eb</i>	<i>jab</i>	<i>da-b</i>

) *vun* *jala-d* *gada=je=vun.*
 2 well-attr.m boy=cop.m=2

‘You are a nice fellow.’

) *zin* *razi=je=zin.*
 1.nom content=cop.m=1

‘I agree.’

) *u-ž* *ši* *adat=e?*
 this-n what custom=cop

‘What is this custom?’

) *va* *q'ina* *za* *borž* *da-bu.*
 2.gen with 1.obl debt(f) neg.cop-f

‘You do not owe me anymore.’

Copulas can attach the past suffix *-ni*:

) *jiḡ-ne* *sad* *jiḡ* *sar* *kačal* *je-ni.*
 day-pl.in one.n day one.m bald cop.m-pst

‘Once upon a time, there was a bald man.’

Copular participles and masdar forms also exist:

) *χab-a* *je-ž* *xu*
 hand-in cop-attr.n bread

‘The bread he had in his hands.’

) *tažir* *kačal-ži-var* *januxli* *je-ni-var* *k'ul-ža* *istetmiš* *dari.*
 merchant bald-obl-adel angry cop-msd.obl-adel house-obl.in make_work neg.do.aor

‘Because the merchant was angry at the Bald, he did not want him to do work around the house anymore.’

For the negative existential in Ismaili Kryz, and more generally in tenses, aspects and moods for which there are no corresponding forms of the copula, the verb *xajiž* ‘to be’ is used instead:

) *ja* *čikar-be-χun* *halama-d* *zad* *šav-ra-da-bu.*
 1pl.gen place-pl.obl-dir such-attr.f thing(f) be.f.ipf-hab-neg-f

‘There s no such thing in our country.’

) *xaj-i-ž* *xaj-ži,* *šajal-ža* *q'il* *yala* *xʷaj-žu.*
 be.pf-ptcp-n be.pf-perf child-obl.in head(f) well be.f.pf-perf.f

‘The past being past, the child’s head got better.’

) *sa-r* *šajara-d* *gada* *xaj-že=ni.*
 one-m good-attr.m boy be.pf-perf=pst

‘He had become a good-looking fellow.’

) *ʕac'in da-b-xa-na vin...*
 satiated neg-hpl-be.pf-cond 2pl

'If you are not satiated...'

) *a-n-iʕ juz manat xaj-iʒ q'ʔajnim šijiz nukarčiluʕ^{wal} ir-eni ki?*
 3-h-super hundred manat be.pf-msd irreal.cond why service do.ipf-pst excl

'If the Bald Man had one hundred manats, would he ever work as a servant?'

Possessive predication is expressed by copula predicates. In Ismaili Kryz, the possessor is in the superlocative case:

) *kačal-ʒi-ʕ sa-b q'usu-d badaj jav-ni.*
 bald-obl-super one-f old-attr.f grandmother cop.f-pst

'The Bald Man had an elderly grandmother.'

) *za baba-ji-ʕ sa-b ʕaʔta-d jaba ja-v-miš.*
 1.gen grandfather-obl-super one-f long-attr.f pitchfork(f) cop-f-evid.pst

'My grandfather had a long pitchfork.'

) *ug-uʕ čara da-d-ni.*
 ref.m-super solution neg.cop-n-pst

'He had no choice.'

4.9. Information structure

Agents being usually topics, their unmarked position is clause-initial; non-topicalized Patients follow the Agent and precede the verb. However, the order of arguments can be modified for pragmatic purposes. For instance, focused constituents tend to occur in preverbal position, with heavy stress, and obvious topics can be postposed to the verb:

) *k'ul xura-r ʕalt'un-a.*
 house(f) man.obl-erg pv.ipf.f.build-hab

'It is men who build houses.'

) *hala* *ja-v* *ja* *daj?*
 where cop-f 1pl.gen mother
 ‘Where is our mother?’

5. Lexicon

Kryz has many, often old Azeri borrowing, sometimes hard to recognize, for instance (Ismailli) *beli* < *böyük(lü)* ‘big’. Hardly any other donor language has been identified.

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